

- (c) Sumatra, Java, Lombok, Bali
(d) Bali, Sumatra, Java, Lombok

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (b)

- The correct sequence of the Islands of Indonesia from West to East is - Sumatra, Java, Bali and Lombok.
- Indonesia's islands can be grouped into the Greater Sunda Islands of Sumatra (Sumatera), Java (Jawa), the southern extent of Borneo (Kalimantan), and Celebes (Sulawesi); the Lesser Sunda Islands (Nusa Tenggara) of Bali and a chain of islands that runs eastward through Timor; the Moluccas (Maluku) between Celebes and the island of New Guinea; and the western extent of New Guinea (generally known as Papua).
- The capital, Jakarta, is located near the northwestern coast of Java.

35. Which of the following Islands is NOT located in the Caribbean Sea?

- (a) Grenada (b) Montserrat
(c) Madeira (d) Anguilla

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

- The Caribbean Islands is a massive archipelago located in the Caribbean Sea that can be subdivided into a few different regions: the Lucayan Archipelago, the Greater Antilles, the Lesser Antilles and the ABC Islands.
- There are 13 sovereign states and 17 dependent territories in the Caribbean, and the predominant languages are English, Spanish, French, Dutch and Antillean Creole. Major islands include - Anguilla, Antigua, British Virgin Islands, Grenada, Montserrat, Saint Martin, etc.
- Madeira Islands, is an archipelago of volcanic origin in the North Atlantic Ocean, belonging to Portugal. It comprises two inhabited islands, Madeira and Porto Santo, and two uninhabited groups, the Desertas and the Selvagens.

36. Which of the following is not a part of Polynesia group of Islands?

- (a) Tonga (b) Tuvalu
(c) Tahiti (d) Tinian

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

Tonga, Tuvalu and Tahiti are part of the Polynesian Islands. Tahiti is an island of French Polynesia and French Polynesia as a whole is a part of Polynesia.

The Lakes and Water Falls

Lakes are among the most varied features of the earth's surface. They occupy the hollow of the land surface in which water accumulates. * Important lakes of the world include – **Caspian Sea, Lake Chad**, lakes of U.S.A. and Canada (Lake **Superior, Huron, Erie and Ontario**), Lake Victoria, Aral Sea, Nyasa, Lake **Baikal**, Great Bear Lake, Lake **Titicaca**, **Dead Sea**, Lake Crater, etc. Based on the total area occupied and volume, the **largest lake** in the world is the **Caspian Sea** of Eurasia. The lake covers an area of 371000 km². Caspian is a **brackish water lake**. The Ural and Volga rivers drain into its northern part. To the south of the Caspian Sea is the Kara-Bogaz Bay which has a salinity of approx 300-350‰. The Great Lakes of North America are located in the Northeastern part of the continent. * **Lake Superior** is the **world's largest freshwater Lake** (Note - Lake Huron and Michigan are technically a single lake. On this basis lake Huron-Michigan is the largest freshwater lake by surface area in the world). It is one of the great lakes located between USA and Canada. * Lake Baikal of Russia is the **World's deepest lake** having a maximum depth of 1642 meter. Baikal is more than 25 million years old. Lake Baikal is also known as the Sacred Sea. * **Lake Tanganyika** is the **world's second deepest lake at 1470 meters**. It is also the world's **longest freshwater lake** (670 km). * **Lake Titicaca** is located on the border of Peru and Bolivia. It is the **highest navigable lake** in the world. It is 280 meters (919 feet) deep. * **Lake Victoria** is located between **Tanzania, Uganda and Kenya**. * **The Dead Sea** is a salt lake bordered by Jordan, Israel and Palestine (West Bank occupied by Israel). * **The Aral Sea** is a salt water lake on the borders of Kazakhstan and Uzbekistan. **Lake Van** is the most saline lake in the world, with salinity reaching as high as 330‰ (according to Savindra Singh Book). Lake Van is located in Turkiye. **Great Slave, Great Bear, Reindeer, Winnipeg, and Athabasca** are some of the important lakes in Canada. * **Uranium City** is located near Lake Athabasca. * **Lake Boiling** is located in Dominica. * **Red Lagoon** is in Bolivia close to the Chilean border and Lake Urmia is in Iran. * **Finger Lakes** are a group of small lakes located in New York State. * **Five Flower Lake** is located in Sichuan Province China. * Finland is a Nordic country located in Northern Europe. Finland is known as the 'Garden of Lakes'/'Land of Thousand Lakes'. * **Lake Saimaa** is the largest lake in Finland and fourth largest natural freshwater lake in Europe. Cities that are located near the Great Lakes of America are – **Duluth** near Lake Superior (North America), **Chicago** near Lake Michigan, and **Buffalo** near Lake Erie. The city of Detroit is located on the banks of Detroit River.

Lakes are water bodies surrounded by land on all sides. They vary tremendously in size, shape, depth and mode of

formation. Hence keeping in mind the various competitive examinations, the following relevant facts have been provided regarding lakes-

WORLD

- The largest freshwater lake – By volume-Lake Baikal, by the total surface area covered - Lake Superior.
- Largest saltwater lake – Caspian Sea (Russia, Azerbaijan, Turkmenistan, Iran, Kazakhstan)
- Largest lake in the world – Caspian Sea.
- Most saline lake in the world – Lake Assal (Djibouti).
- Lake with the lowest elevation – Dead Sea (Jordan, Israel & West Bank)
- Highest lake in the world – Ojos del Salado (Chile - Argentina)
- The highest navigable lake in the world – Lake Titicaca (Peru, Bolivia).

LAGOON

A lagoon is a body of water separated from larger bodies of water by a natural barrier. Natural barriers may include sandbars, barrier reefs, coral reefs, etc. Chilika (Odisha) is the largest lagoon in India whereas the New Caledonian barrier reef (in New Caledonia an overseas region of France) is the largest lagoon in the world.

Based on volume, the largest lakes of different continents are (except the caspian sea)-

Continents	Lakes
Africa	Tanganyika
Asia	Baikal
Europe	Ladoga
North America	Superior

Deepest Lakes in the Different Continents

Africa	Tanganyika
Asia	Baikal
Europe	Hornindalsvatnet
North America	Great Slave
South America	O' Higgins / San Martin
Antarctica	Vostok
Australia	St. Clair

Top Five Largest lakes in the World Based on volume

(1) Caspian Sea (2) Baikal (3) Tanganyika (4) Superior (5) Malawi

Top Five Largest Lakes in the world based on the Surface area-

(1) Caspian Sea (2) Superior (3) Victoria (4) Huron (5) Michigan.

Top Five Deepest Lakes in the World-

(1) Baikal (2) Tanganyika (3) Caspian Sea (4) Vostok (5) O' Higgins / San Martin

Largest Lakes of Different Continents Based on the total Surface area covered –

Asia	Caspian Sea (*)
Africa	Victoria
Australia	Lake Eyre
Europe	Ladoga
North America	Superior
South America	Titicaca**
Antarctica	Vostok

Note : *The Caspian Sea is a transcontinental lake covering both Europe and Asia, otherwise if removed then Lake Baikal is the largest lake in Asia.

**The largest lake by surface area in South America is lake Maracaibo (lagoon lake) in Venezuela.

The Great Lakes of North America and the important cities located near them.

The great lakes of North America consist of five lakes – Lake Huron, Lake Michigan, Lake Superior, Lake Ontario and Lake Erie. These lakes are known for their industrial clusters and inland navigation.

Lake Superior, Lake Huron, Erie and Ontario create the border between USA and Canada.

Lake	City
Superior	Thunder Bay (Canada), Duluth (United States of America).
Michigan	Chicago (United states of America).
Huron	Sarnia (Canada) and Bay City (U.S.A.)
Erie	Toledo, Cleveland and Buffalo (USA)
Ontario	Toronto and Hamilton (Canada)

*When rivers plunge down in a sudden fall of some height, they are called waterfalls.

*The highest waterfall in the world is **Salto Angel** (979 m). The waterfall is located on Rio Churun which is a tributary of the river Rio Carrao which flows through Canaima National Park in Venezuela. **'Rio Carrao is a tributary of Rio Orinoco.'**

***Tugela waterfalls** is located on the river Tugela in South Africa. * **Victoria Falls** lies in South-Central Africa on the borders of Zambia and Zimbabwe. The falls are located on the river Zambezi. In 1989 it was included in the list of World Heritage Sites.

***Ribbon falls** is located on the river Ribbon Creek in Yosemite National Park in California. It is 491m high.

* Niagara Falls is located on the river Niagara on the international border between Canada and USA. * **Browne Falls** (836 m) is located in New Zealand.

1. Which one of the following lakes of West Africa has become dry and turned into a desert?

(a) Lake Victoria (b) Lake Faguibine
(c) Lake Oguta (d) Lake Volta

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Lake Faguibine in Mali, West Africa has dried up and turned into a desert.

2. Which among the following is not correctly matched?

Lake	-	Country
A. Balkhash	-	Kazakhstan
B. Titicaca	-	Bolivia - Peru
C. Erie	-	USA - Canada
D. Baikal	-	Ukraine
(a) B		(b) C
(c) A		(d) D

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

The correct match is as follows :

Lake	Country
Balkhash/Balkhara	Kazakhstan
Titicaca	Bolivia - Peru
Erie	U.S.A. - Canada
Baikal	Russia

3. Lake Balkhash is situated in which one of the following countries?

(a) Kazakhstan (b) Kyrgyzstan
(c) Russia (d) Turkmenistan

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (a)

Lake Balkhash is situated in east-central Kazakhstan. Lake Balkhash is the largest lake in Central Asia and fifteenth largest in the world.

4. Niagara Falls in North America is located between :

(a) Lake Superior and Lake Michigan
(b) Lake Michigan and Lake Huron
(c) Lake Huron and Lake Ontario
(d) Lake Ontario and Lake Erie
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2020

Ans. (d)

Niagara Falls is located between Lake Ontario and Lake Erie in North America. It is situated on the Niagara River on the border of the United States and Canada. The Niagara River connects Lake Erie and Lake Ontario.

5. Which of the following is the second deepest and the longest lake in the world?

(a) Tanganyika Lake (b) Baikal Lake
(c) Superior Lake (d) Great Bear Lake

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (a)

Lake Tanganyika is the second deepest lake (1470 m) after Lake Baikal and the longest freshwater lake in the world. The question here relates to freshwater lakes; if it is related to salt water lakes, the question will be incorrect.

6. Which one is not a part of Great Lakes ?

(a) Bear (b) Superior
(c) Huron (d) Michigan

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

Ans. (a)

The **Great Lakes** is a series of interconnected freshwater lakes located in Northeastern America. It consists of Superior, Michigan, Huron, Erie and Ontario. Bear is not included in the group.

7. The correct sequence of the Great Lakes of the USA from east to west is

(a) Huron–Michigan–Ontario–Superior–Erie
(b) Superior–Ontario–Erie–Michigan–Huron
(c) Ontario–Erie–Huron–Michigan–Superior
(d) Erie–Huron–Michigan–Ontario–Superior

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

The correct sequence of the Great Lakes in the USA from east to west is Ontario - Erie - Huron - Michigan - Superior.

8. Which of the following lakes lies entirely in the U.S.A.?

(a) Lake Michigan (b) Lake Huron
(c) Lake Superior (d) Lake Erie

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

9. Which of the following lakes is located entirely within the United States?

(a) Michigan (b) Superior
(c) Ontario (d) Erie

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Arrange the following lakes in correct descending order of their area using the code given below:

1. Great Bear 2. Baikal
3. Victoria 4. Superior

Code :

- (a) 4, 3, 2, 1 (b) 3, 2, 1, 4
(c) 4, 2, 1, 3 (d) 3, 1, 4, 2

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (a)

The lakes according to their area in descending order are –		
Lake		Area (sq km)
Superior	-	82097
Victoria	-	68870
Baikal	-	31500
Great Bear	-	31153

11. The largest fresh water lake in the world is ?

- (a) Lake Windermere
(b) Lake Loch Ness
(c) Lake Baikal
(d) Lake Superior

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (d)

The largest freshwater lake in the world is Lake Superior which is one of the constituent lakes of the Great Lakes on the Canada–United States border. Therefore, the correct answer is option (d).

12. Which of the following is the oldest and deepest lake of the world?

- (a) Lake Baikal (b) Lake Huron
(c) Victoria Lake (d) Lake Winnipeg

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) (Re-Exam) 2015

Ans. (a)

Lake Baikal is the world's oldest and deepest lake. Its maximum depth is approximately 1642 meters and it is more than 25 million years old.

13. Which of the following is the oldest and deepest lake in the world?

- (a) Baikal Lake (b) Great Bear Lake
(c) Karda Lake (d) Lincanbur Lake

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (a)

Lake Baikal is the world's oldest and deepest freshwater lake. Its maximum depth is 1642 meters. It is more than 25 million years old.

14. Which is the deepest lake of the world ?

- (a) Titicaca (b) Victoria
(c) Baikal (d) Dead Sea

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2002

Ans. (c)

The deepest lake in the world is Lake Baikal in Siberia, Russia. It is a natural lake that is 1642 meters deep.

Lake Titicaca is located on the border of Peru and Bolivia. Its depth is 280 meters (919 feet).

Lake Victoria is located between Tanzania , Uganda & Kenya. It has a maximum depth of 84 meters and an average depth of 40 meters.

The Dead Sea is a salt lake lying on the borders Israel , Palestine and Jordan. Its average depth is 120 meters.

15. On the basis of area and volume, the largest lake of the world is :

- (a) Aral Sea (b) Caspian Sea
(c) Baikal Lake (d) Michigan Lake

U.P.P.C.S. (Spl) (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

A lake is a body of water surrounded basin on land. On the basis of area and volume, the largest lake of the world is Caspian Sea of Eurasia. The sea has a surface area of 371,000 km². It is a saltwater lake.

16. Finger Lake Region is located in :

- (a) Australia (b) Austria
(c) U.S.A (d) Britain

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (c)

Finger Lakes region refers to a series of small lakes in north west of New York, USA.

17. Which of the following is called 'Garden of lakes' ?

- (a) Finland (b) Sweden
(c) New Zealand (d) Greenland

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2014

Ans. (a)

Finland is a Nordic country located in Northern Europe. There are approximately 187888 lakes and 178917 islands in Finland. This is the reason it is known as the Garden of lakes. Finland's largest lake Saimaa is Europe's fourth largest lake.

18. Which of the following is called the 'land of one thousand lakes'?

- (a) Finland (b) Sweden

- (c) Greenland (d) U.S.A.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2015

Ans. (a)

Finland is called the land of one thousand lakes.

19. Which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?

- (a) Boiling lake - Dominica
(b) Five Flower Lake - Mongolia
(c) Red Lagoon - Bolivia
(d) Great Slave lake - Canada

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

The correctly matched pairs are as follows:

Boiling Lake	-	Dominica
Five Flower lake	-	Sichuan, China
Red Lagoon	-	Bolivia
Great Slave lake	-	Canada

Thus option (b) is not correctly matched.

20. Which of the following cities is located on Lake Superior?

- (a) Chicago (b) Buffalo
(c) Detroit (d) Duluth

U.P.R.O./A.R.O (Mains) 2014

Ans. (d)

Duluth is the second largest city on the shore of Lake Superior (North America).

21. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

- (a) Titicaca Lake - Bolivia - Peru
(b) Lake Urmia - Iran
(c) Lake Reindeer - Russia
(d) Lake Athabaska - Canada

U.P.R.O./A.R.O (Mains) 2014

Ans. (c)

The correctly matched pairs of lakes and their countries are as follows:

(Lakes)		(Countries)
Titicaca Lake	—	Bolivia–Peru
Lake Urmia	—	Iran
Lake Reindeer	—	Canada
Lake Athabasca	—	Canada

22. Which is the highest waterfall of the world ?

- (a) Niagara (b) Salto Angel
(c) Ribbon (d) Tugela

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (b)

The highest waterfall of the world is Salto Angel also known as 'Angel Falls' which is 979 meters high. It is located at Rio Churun which is a tributary of Rio Carrao. Rio Carrao is a tributary of Rio Orinoco.

Tugela Falls is located on the Tugela River in South Africa. It is 948 meters high.

23. Which of the following waterfalls is located in Venezuela?

- (a) Victoria Falls (b) Angel Falls
(c) Alfred Creek Falls (d) Tugela Falls

U.P.P.S.C. (R.I.) 2014

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

24. The waterfall 'Victoria' is associated with the river:

- (a) Amazon (b) Missouri
(c) St. Lawrence (d) Zambezi

I.A.S. (Pre) 2003

Ans. (d)

The waterfall 'Victoria' is associated with the River Zambezi located at the border of Zambia and Zimbabwe in Southern-central Africa.

25. With reference to 'Lake Victoria in Africa', which of the following statements is/are correct?

(1) The lake is surrounded by four countries.

(2) It is situated in the African rift valley.

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

Code :

- (a) Only 1 (b) Only 2
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

U.P. R.O./A.R.O. (Mains) 2021

Ans. (b)

Lake Victoria is located between Tanzania, Uganda and Kenya. Its area is 69930 square kilometers and the average depth is 40 meters (maximum depth 84 meters). Lake Victoria is situated in the rift valley. The White Nile River originates from this lake.

26. Consider the following statements:

1. Lake Victoria is the third largest freshwater lake in the world by surface area.
2. It is one of the great lakes of Africa.
3. It is bordered by four countries – Tanzania, Uganda, Rwanda and Kenya.
4. The only outflow from Lake Victoria is the Nile River, which exits the lake near Jinja, Uganda.

Which of the above statements are incorrect?

- (a) 1 and 2 (b) 2 and 4
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 3

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre), 2023

Ans. (d)

Lake Victoria is one of the greatest lake in African continent. Lake Victoria is the second largest freshwater lake in the world by surface area. Lake Victoria is bordered by Tanzania, Uganda and Kenya. Significantly, lake Victoria is included in Great Lakes Region. The African Great lakes are a series of lakes constituting part of the Rift Valley lakes in and around the East African Rift. They include Lake Victoria Lake Tanganyika, Lake Malawi, Lake Turkana, Lake Albert, Lake Kivu and Lake Edward. Hence, Options 1 and 3 are incorrect.

27. Which of the following lakes is a world heritage site?

- (a) Red Lagoon of Bolivia
(b) Boiling Lake of Dominica
(c) Five Flower Lake of China
(d) Plitvice Lake of Croatia

U.P.R.O./A.R.O. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (d)

Plitvice Lake National Park was granted UNESCO World Heritage status in 1979. The beauty of the National Park lies in its sixteen lakes, interconnected by a series of waterfalls, and set in deep woodland populated by rare bird species.

28. Which one of the following is not correctly matched?

- (a) World's tallest waterfall - Tugela Falls
(b) World's largest fresh water lake - Lake Superior
(c) World's highest navigable lake - Lake Titicaca
(d) World's second deepest lake - Lake Tanganyika

U.P.P.C.S.(Pre) (Re. Exam) 2015

Ans. (a)

Angel Falls is located in Venezuela is the highest waterfall in the world. Its height is 979 m, whereas Tugela Falls is the second highest waterfall with a height of 948 m.

29. Which of the following is not correctly matched?

- (a) Baikal – Russian Federation
(b) Malawi – Asia
(c) Caspian Sea – Asia – Europe
(d) Tanganyika – Africa

U.P. RO/ARO (Mains) 2017

Ans. (b)

Baikal	- Russian Federation
Malawi	- Africa
Caspian Sea	- Asia - Europe
Tanganyika	- Africa

30. Which of the following has/have shrunk immensely/ dried up in the recent past due to human activities?

1. Aral Sea
2. Black Sea
3. Lake Baikal

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3
(c) 2 only (d) 1 and 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (a)

Due to human activities, the Aral Sea has become very narrow or almost dried up. The satellite picture of the Aral Sea by NASA was displayed in the year 2014, comparing it with the situation in the year 1989. There has also been some contraction in the Black Sea and Lake Baikal, but it is very little compared to the Aral Sea. Here the question uses adjectival terminology like very compacted/dry, which is true only in the context of the Aral Sea.

31. Which one of the following (Lake – Country) is not correctly matched?

- (a) Maracaibo – Venezuela
(b) Onega – Canada
(c) Michigan – United States of America
(d) Baikal – Russia

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Lake Maracaibo is a lagoon in northwestern Venezuela, the largest lake in South America and one of the oldest on Earth, formed 36 million years ago in the Andes Mountains. Lake Onega is a lake in northwestern Russia, on the territory of the Republic of Karelia, Leningrad Oblast and Vologda Oblast. It belongs to the basin of the Baltic Sea, and is the second-largest lake in Europe after Lake Ladoga, slightly smaller than Lebanon.

Lake Michigan is one of the five Great Lakes of North America. It is the second-largest of the Great Lakes by volume and the third-largest by surface area, after Lake Superior and Lake Huron.

Lake Baikal is an ancient, massive lake in the mountainous Russian region of Siberia, north of the Mongolian border.